NCL Fall 2025 Individual Game Scouting Report

Dear Brynn[redacted]

Thank you for participating in the National Cyber League (NCL) Fall 2025 Season! Our goal is to prepare the next generation of cybersecurity professionals, and your participation is helping achieve that goal.

The NCL was founded in May 2011 to provide an ongoing virtual training ground for collegiate students to develop, practice, and validate their cybersecurity skills in preparation for further learning, industry certifications, and career readiness. The NCL scenario-based challenges were designed around performance-based exam objectives of CompTIA certifications and are aligned to the National Initiative for Cybersecurity Education (NICE) Cybersecurity Workforce Framework published by the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST).

As you look to a future career in cybersecurity, we hope you find this report to be valuable in both validating skills and identifying areas for improvement across the nine NCL skills categories. You can use this NCL Scouting Report to:

- Validate your skills to employers in any job application or professional portfolio;
- Show case your achievements and strengths by including the Score Card view of your performance as part of your résumé or simply sharing the validation link so that others may view the detailed version of this report.

The NCL Fall 2025 Season had 8,520 students/players and 538 faculty/coaches from more than 490 two- and four-year schools & 200 high schools across all 50 U.S. states registered to play. The Individual Game Capture the Flag (CTF) event took place from October 24 through October 26. The Team Game CTF event took place from November 7 through November 9. The games were conducted in real-time for students across the country.

NCL is powered by Cyber Skyline's cloud-based skills evaluation platform. Cyber Skyline hosted the scenario-driven cybersecurity challenges for players to compete and track their progress in real-time.

To validate this report, please access: cyberskyline.com/report/7PKFRGYE78R0

Based on the performance detailed in this NCL Scouting Report, you have earned **16 hours** of Continuing Education Units (CEUs) as approved by CompTIA. You can learn more about the NCL - CompTIA alignment via nationalcyberleague.org/partners.

Congratulations for your participation in the NCL Fall 2025 Individual Game! We hope you will continue to develop your knowledge and skills and make meaningful contributions as part of the Information Security workforce!

Dr. David Zeichick
NCL Commissioner

POWERED BY CYBER SKYLINE

NATIONAL CYBER LEAGUE SCORE CARD

NCL FALL 2025 INDIVIDUAL GAME

NATIONAL RANK

421ST PLACE OUT OF 7873

PERCENTILE

95TH

YOUR TOP CATEGORIES

CRYPTOGRAPHY	PASSWORD CRACKING	NETWORK TRAFFIC ANALYSIS
98TH PERCENTILE	98TH PERCENTILE	96TH PERCENTILE

79.2%
ACCURACY

Average: 61.0%

cyberskyline.com/report
ID: 7PKFRGYE78R0

NCL Fall 2025 Individual Game

The NCL Individual Game is designed for student players nationwide to compete in realtime in the categories listed below. The Individual Game evaluates the technical cybersecurity skills of the individual, without the assistance of others.

421 ST PLACE OUT OF 7873
NATIONAL RANK

2145 POINTS OUT OF 3000
PERFORMANCE SCORE

79.2% ACCURACY

82.0% COMPLETION

95th National Percentile

Average: 974.0 Points

Average: 61.0%

Average: 40.1%

Cryptography

315 POINTS OUT OF 355

90.5% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 95.0%

Identify techniques used to encrypt or obfuscate messages and leverage tools to extract the plaintext.

Enumeration & Exploitation

200 POINTS OUT OF 300

53.8% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 87.5%

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in code and compiled binaries.

Forensics

190 POINTS OUT OF 300

60.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 80.0%

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to analyze, process, recover, and/or investigate digital evidence in a computer-related incident.

Log Analysis

200 POINTS OUT OF 300

91.7% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 78.6%

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to establish a baseline for normal operation and identify malicious activities using log files from various services.

Network Traffic Analysis

210 POINTS OUT OF 300

66.7% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 85.7%

Identify malicious and benign network traffic to demonstrate an understanding of potential security breaches.

Open Source Intelligence

295 POINTS OUT OF 385

82.8% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 85.7%

Utilize publicly available information such as search engines, public repositories, social media, and more to gain in-depth knowledge on a topic or target.

Password Cracking

275 POINTS OUT OF 360

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 78.3%

Identify types of password hashes and apply various techniques to efficiently determine plaintext passwords.

Scanning & Reconnaissance

240 POINTS OUT OF 300

87.5% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 93.3%

Identify and use the proper tools to gain intelligence about a target including its services and potential vulnerabilities.

Web Application Exploitation

120 POINTS OUT OF 300

66.7% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 33.3%

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in online services.

Note: Survey module (100 points) was excluded from this report.

Cryptography Module

Identify techniques used to encrypt or obfuscate messages and leverage tools to extract the plaintext.

185 TH PLACE OUT OF 7873
NATIONAL RANK

315 POINTS OUT OF 355
PERFORMANCE SCORE

90.5% ACCURACY

95.0% COMPLETION

98th National Percentile

Average: 157.0 Points

Average: 69.5%

Average: 58.2%

Baking Soda (Easy)

50 POINTS OUT OF 50 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Analyze and obtain the plaintext from text encoded with common number bases.

ROTten domains (Easy)

45 POINTS OUT OF 45 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Analyze and obtain plaintext for messages encrypted with a shift cipher.

Convenience (Easy)

60 POINTS OUT OF 60 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Analyze and obtain the plaintext from text encrypted with Vigenère cipher.

01101011 01100101 01111001 (Medium)

0 POINTS OUT OF 40 | 0.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 0.0%

Decrypt a message using an XOR key.

Squirtle (Medium)

60 POINTS OUT OF 60 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Analyze and exploit a DES encryption implementation using known weak keys.

Temet Nosce (Hard)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Exploit a flaw in AES encryption to decrypt text with an unknown secret key.

Enumeration & Exploitation Module

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in code and compiled binaries.

385 TH PLACE OUT OF 7873
NATIONAL RANK

200 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

53.8% ACCURACY

87.5% COMPLETION

96th National Percentile

Average: 98.2 Points

Average: 60.4%

Average: 49.4%

Deno Finds a Way (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

66.7% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Review source code and exploit a command injection vulnerability to escalate privileges.

Stacked (Medium)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

42.9% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Perform an HTTP-triggered stack overflow to retrieve critical information from the server.

Sewer System (Hard)

0 POINTS OUT OF 100

0.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 0.0%

Exploit a race condition in software to return protected data.

Forensics Module

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to analyze, process, recover, and/or investigate digital evidence in a computer-related incident.

526 TH PLACE OUT OF 7873
NATIONAL RANK

190 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

60.0% ACCURACY

86.7% COMPLETION

94th National Percentile

Average: 115.2 Points

Average: 45.9%

Average: 48.4%

Four & Six (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

80.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Use a forensics tool to examine unallocated space for files.

This Bytes (Medium)

75 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 75.0%

Research JPEG specifications to repair an image.

Stage Left (Hard)

15 POINTS OUT OF 100

14.3% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 33.3%

Fix a corrupted SQLite database file and analyze the tables.

Log Analysis Module

Utilize the proper tools and techniques to establish a baseline for normal operation and identify malicious activities using log files from various services.

919 TH PLACE OUT OF 7873
NATIONAL RANK

200 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

91.7% ACCURACY

78.6% COMPLETION

89th National Percentile

Average: 160.8 Points

Average: 55.3%

Average: 61.1%

Process This (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

85.7% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Examine parsed Sysmon JSON process tree logs to determine a chain of events.

Brute Force (Medium)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Identify a brute force attack by analyzing patterns of malicious actor behavior in web server logs.

Stolen Swipe (Hard)

0 POINTS OUT OF 100

0.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 0.0%

Parse and correlate ATM and EMV Field 55 logs (ISO 8583 standard) to identify a fraudulent transaction.

Network Traffic Analysis Module

Identify malicious and benign network traffic to demonstrate an understanding of potential security breaches.

359 TH PLACE OUT OF 7873
NATIONAL RANK

210 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

66.7% ACCURACY

85.7% COMPLETION

96th National Percentile

Average: 112.2 Points

Average: 51.6%

Average: 45.0%

RMM Tool (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

83.3% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Analyze DNS packet requests and responses to identify a suspicious download.

Drive-by Download (Medium)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

75.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Identify details of a drive-by-download attack and de-obfuscate JavaScript.

The Insider (Hard)

10 POINTS OUT OF 100

25.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 33.3%

Reconstruct a file from UDP packets and decode VBA script.

Open Source Intelligence Module

Utilize publicly available information such as search engines, public repositories, social media, and more to gain in-depth knowledge on a topic or target.

1059 TH PLACE OUT OF 7873 NATIONAL RANK	295 POINTS OUT OF 385 PERFORMANCE SCORE	82.8% ACCURACY	85.7% COMPLETION
87th National Percentile	Average: 213.9 Points	Average: 58.5%	Average: 65.3%

Rules of Conduct (Easy) Introductory challenge on acceptable conduct during NCL.	30 POINTS OUT OF 30	100.0% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 100.0%
Cooking Breakfast (Easy) Parse Chef (esolang) code to determine what input it requires.	45 POINTS OUT OF 45	100.0% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 100.0%
NotPetya (Easy) Gather key information on NotPetya malware.	100 POINTS OUT OF 100	88.9% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 100.0%
Flamed (Medium) Use open source tools to find patterns between GPS locations.	15 POINTS OUT OF 55	50.0% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 50.0%
Material (Medium) Use the EDGAR database to filter 8-K filings.	65 POINTS OUT OF 80	80.0% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 80.0%
I Cee Stuff (Hard) Use ICS/OT OSINT tools do passive recon on infrastructure.	40 POINTS OUT OF 75	60.0% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 60.0%

Password Cracking Module

Identify types of password hashes and apply various techniques to efficiently determine plaintext passwords.

209 TH PLACE OUT OF 7873 NATIONAL RANK	275 POINTS OUT OF 360 PERFORMANCE SCORE	100.0% ACCURACY	78.3% COMPLETION
98th National Percentile	Average: 163.6 Points	Average: 86.3%	Average: 50.2%

Hashing (Easy)

40 POINTS OUT OF 40 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Generate hashes for passwords with the MD5, NTLM, and SHA256 hashing algorithms.

Crack You One More Time (Easy)

50 POINTS OUT OF 50 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Crack MD5 and SHA1 password hashes using password cracking tools.

Oph the Dome (Easy)

60 POINTS OUT OF 60 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Crack Windows NTLM password hashes using rainbow tables.

Redacted (Medium)

50 POINTS OUT OF 50 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Crack an insecure password for a protected PDF file and recover redacted information.

MasKquerade (Medium)

60 POINTS OUT OF 60 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 100.0%

Build a wordlist or pattern rule to crack password hashes of a known pattern.

Enterprise (Hard)

15 POINTS OUT OF 100 | 100.0% ACCURACY | COMPLETION: 16.7%

Build a wordlist to crack passwords not found in common wordlists.

Scanning & Reconnaissance Module

Identify and use the proper tools to gain intelligence about a target including its services and potential vulnerabilities.

460 TH PLACE OUT OF 7873
NATIONAL RANK

240 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

87.5% ACCURACY

93.3% COMPLETION

95th National Percentile

Average: 152.1 Points

Average: 72.9%

Average: 58.2%

Portscan (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Use nmap to scan a machine and discover open ports.

Chain (Medium)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

83.3% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Enumerate SMB to locate and retrieve a private SSH key.

I'm TXT (Hard)

40 POINTS OUT OF 100

80.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 80.0%

Enumerate a DNS service to discover hidden files in DNS TXT records.

Web Application Exploitation Module

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in online services.

862 ND PLACE OUT OF 7873
NATIONAL RANK

120 POINTS OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE

66.7% ACCURACY

33.3% COMPLETION

90th National Percentile

Average: 120.0 Points

Average: 73.0%

Average: 31.8%

Browser (Easy)

100 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 100.0%

Exploit a client-side validation weakness in a web application.

Ersatz Motel (Medium)

10 POINTS OUT OF 100

33.3% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 20.0%

Perform a SQL Injection Union attack to retrieve information.

Micro Fail (Hard)

10 POINTS OUT OF 100

100.0% ACCURACY

COMPLETION: 20.0%

Access sensitive files on a webserver by chaining together a prototype pollution attack with an XML external entity injection attack.